

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 4 ♠

Declarer: North

Board: 3

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 3 ♥

Declarer: East

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A 9 8 3

♥ K Q 3

♦ A 5 2

♣ J 5 4

♠ K 10 5

♥ A 5

♦ Q J 8 4

♣ K Q 7 3



♠ 2

♥ J 10 9 8 6 2

♦ 10 9 7

♣ 10 8 6

♠ Q J 7 6 4

♥ 7 4

♦ K 6 3

♣ A 9 2

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

2♥

Pass

2♠

Pass

3NT

Pass

4♠

All Pass

4♠ by North
range.

A 4♠ contract is definitely the place to be.

North's 1NT opening shows 15-17 points. What is your bid?

With 11 points you are strong enough to force to game. With a 5-card ♠ suit you should transfer partner to ♠s by bidding 2♥. Partner dutifully responds 2♠.

You must make a bid that will force partner to game, but at the same time inform him that you have only 5 ♠s (remember, your transfer promised **AT LEAST** 5). The bid that says both of these facts at once is 3NT. Partner comes back with 4♠. What say you?

You say pass.

You might revalue your hand up to 12 points now that an 8-card fit has been discovered, but with partner's maximum of 17 you are nowhere near slam

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 5 3
 ♥ K 9 8 7 4 2
 ♦ A 10 6
 ♣ 6 5

♠ Q 9 2
 ♥ 3
 ♦ Q J 9 8
 ♣ A 9 7 3 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A J 7 6
 ♥ Q 6
 ♦ K 7 5 3
 ♣ K Q 4

♠ K 10 8 4
 ♥ A J 10 5
 ♦ 4 2
 ♣ J 10 8

West	North	East	South
		1NT	Pass
2♦	Pass	2♥	Pass
3♥			
All Pass			

3♥ by East

bidding game rather than just inviting. The problem with the revaluing is that counting doubleton points in the long-trump hand is deceiving. If you do end up ruffing one or both of those suits it will not add any tricks to your total since you would make your small trumps anyway. So when you have a 6-card suit it is more accurate to not revalue.

As you can see, making even 9 tricks is going to be a challenge.

East opens 1NT.

You have 9 points and 6 ♥s. You transfer partner to ♥s by bidding 2♦. He bids 2♥, as instructed.

What is your next bid?

You want to tell partner you have invitational strength. You also want to tell him that you have 6 ♥s, and that the contract must be played in ♥s. The bid that says both is 3♥.

Partner declines your invitation by passing.

A comment is in order about revaluing your hand. Since partner must have at least a doubleton ♥ it is tempting to claim that with the 8-card fit you should add one point for each of your doubletons, bringing your total to 11. If you did this then you should be